

components to measure height, area and volume. Using software, the system analyses these images and calculates statistical process control (SPC) results in these areas. This information is then used to automatically decide whether a piece is perfect or needs to be rejected. Recent 64-bit 3D systems can inspect at a speed of 171 cm² per second, with a 14-micrometre resolution.

It is important to note that one of the key reasons for the dramatic growth of AOI systems in the past year is the associated developments related to LEDs. LED illumination modules are now available in varying wavelengths and increased intensities. These are now the preferred light source for optical inspection, as they have a long life, consume less power, are stable over time, can be turned off or on instantaneously and controlled accurately.

Wireless: T&M for 3G/4G networks and equipment

The growth of wireless communications and network convergence has spurred the growth of wireless-capable T&M equipment for monitoring the quality-of-service (QoS) of mobile networks and testing the associated devices including phones. From protocol analysers and emulators to field testers, T&M and the related systems are all becoming wireless-savvy.

Innovative Products Launched Last Year...

Qmax Semiconductor IC Test System

Indigenously designed and developed in India, Qmax's QST4416-FC is meant to test precision electrical parameters (static and dynamic) for medium-power (around 100VA) semiconductor linear ICs, mixed-signal ICs and low-pin-count digital ICs. This semiconductor test system is used by design engineers to perform silicon-level wafer back-end testing, high-speed testing in IC production, outgoing quality assurance and incoming quality assurance. It includes exhaustive characterisation tools for R&D and statistical tools for production.

The QST4416-FC is designed using the latest high-speed, high-performance FPGA from Xilinx and high-speed SRAM technology for vector processing. It includes latest LabView 2009 software features and PCIe interface. Graphical user interface based programming eliminates the need for knowledge of any special programming language. The equipment is low-cost compared to its counterparts from other countries, as claimed by Qmax. (For details, visit www.qmaxtest.com)



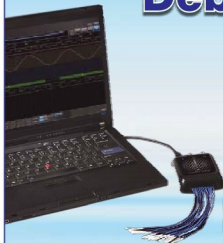
Sciencetech Caddo Mini Lab

All-in-one is now becoming a buzzword in the T&M industry too. Sciencetech's Caddo 820 is a single platform comprising oscilloscope, function generator and DC power supply in a single space-saving housing. It forms an independent test lab for many applications at a very affordable price point, as claimed by the company.

Caddo 820 is a microcontroller-based product with two-channel oscilloscope providing 40MHz trigger bandwidth and 1MHz function generator providing sine, square, triangular and DC outputs. (For details, visit <http://www.sciencetech.bz/>)



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